



PHOTOS BY GETTY IMAGES

THE ROAR of fans at a stadium near New York during the India-Pakistan clash at the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2024 might have seemed out of place in a country where baseball and basketball dominate. However, cricket's roots in the US run deeper than many realise.

Cricket arrived in the US as early as 1709, gaining popularity in elite academic institutions by the 19th century. However, after independence, as America distanced itself from British colonial influence, cricket was overshadowed by baseball, its homegrown alternative. Now, over three centuries later, it is making an unexpected comeback.

Baseball and basketball generate billions in revenue in the US, while cricket, predominantly played by immigrants (mainly from India), would have to build mass appeal among locals. Cricket's growing financial potential has contributed to its inclusion in the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics. But how much can the Olympics boost cricket's presence in the US?

KEEPING THE SCORE

620

MILLION

Viewership of Tata IPL in 2024

87.6

BILLION

Live minutes globally for the India-Australia World Cup final 2023; 46% growth over the India-Sri Lanka final in 2011

₹48,390

CRORE

Price at which IPL media rights were sold for the 2023-27 cycle

\$12

BILLION

IPL's brand value at the end of 2024